

Community

Featuring an article about the rise of Indian entrepreneurship and a succinct tutorial on building your own URL shortener

**Painted on**

Watch this painted movie of paintings telling the life of Vincent Van Gogh
<http://dgit.in/1aRprKD>

Programming idiosyncracies

The programming world is a world of geeky obscurity to the layman, full of jargon that bamboozle the heck out of everyone. But coding and programming life isn't without its funny moments; some of them have gone on to become quite epic, too, as far as pop cultural references go. Here's a quick insight into the idiosyncracies that make us geeks human.

**IP over Avian**

If satellites and undersea cables can't get the Internets to you then pigeons will. IP over Avian was even tested successfully in Norway with nine pigeons, having a packet return time of just 3000-6000 seconds. So if you don't mind getting your email with a few feathers and pigeon droppings here and there then a 10 megabeaks/sec plan should suffice.

Ninety-ninety rule

It states that "The first 90 percent of the code accounts for the first 90 percent of the development time. The remaining 10 percent of the code accounts for the other 90 percent of the development time." If you've ever been part of a coding endeavour then you'll know this to be true. Simply put, it means that it takes more time and code than originally planned.

**Hexspeak**

While the rabble of the IT world have their communication limited to the decimal system, the "Neo"s prefer Hexspeak. It's even in practice right now. Example: 0xDEADD00D which translates to "Dead dude" is used in Android to indicate an error. 0x8BADFOOD ("ate bad food") in IOS is used as an error message for slow-poke applications.

**Internet Oracle**

While not the sweet old lady from the Matrix, the internet does have many oracles whom the sub-servant coders turn to when the need for answers arises. Birthed at Harward in 1976 the oracle began as a simple "QnA" program where the person asking a question would be given someone else's question to answer. And soon enough, nerd humour ensued.

FINO

When you are programming and you simply can't figure out what to do with a particular variable/data type you resort to a FINO queue. Abbreviated in the same manner as FIFO (First In First Out) and LIFO (Last In First Out), FINO stands for First In Never Out. It's the Azkaban of coding where you send ones and zeroes to languish forever.

**User error**

Ever had the computer insult your intelligence? That depends, have you ever encountered the following error messages – PEBCAK, PICNIC or ID10T. These translate to "Problem Exists Between Computer And Keyboard" in some form or the other. It's often used by tech-support personnel too, so now you'll know when you're called an idiot.